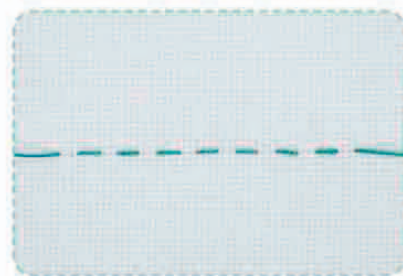


How to hand-stitch and embroider

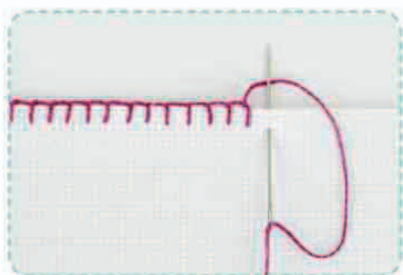
Use this selection of common embroidery and hand stitches to decorate your projects. A small embroidery motif on a toy, blanket, or piece of clothing can set it apart as something lovingly crafted and to be cherished for years. Always secure your stitches at the back of the work or with the thread tails hidden beneath satin stitch.

Running stitch -----



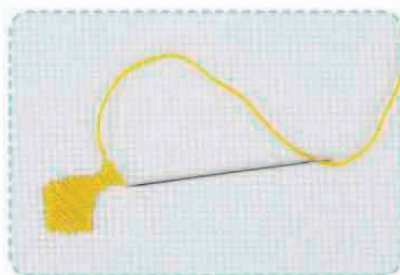
Work the needle and thread in and out of the fabric, creating stitches of even length that are evenly spaced.

Blanket stitch -----



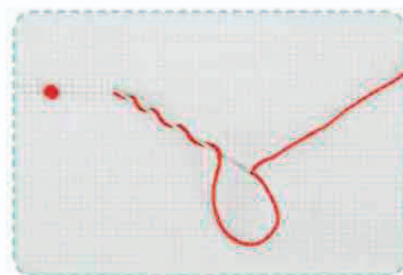
Working from left to right, insert the needle through the right side of the fabric. As the needle appears at the edge, wrap the thread under the needle and pull the needle through.

Satin stitch -----



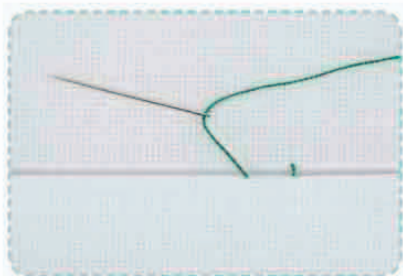
Bring the needle to the front at one side of the shape to be worked. Take it over the shape and to the back on the opposite side. Continue using long, smooth stitches without pulling, as this would pucker the fabric.

French knot -----

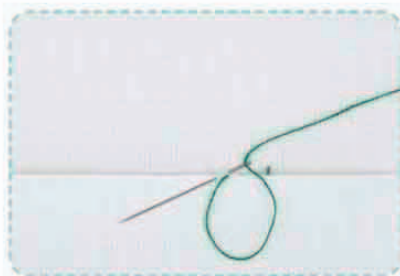


Bring the needle to the front of the fabric. Wrap the thread around the needle, then push the needle to the back, just next to the hole where it emerged from the back.

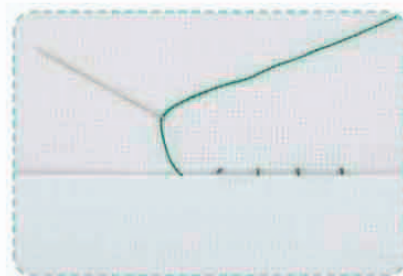
Flat fell stitch -----



1 Great for seaming two overlapping layers on a project, particularly the raw edge of a non-fraying fabric such as felt. Working from right to left, take the needle to the front through both layers of fabric.



2 Reinsert the needle through the first layer of fabric only, just above where the thread came out, and then bring it back out, one stitch along, through both layers of fabric.



3 Continue working, taking care not to pull the thread too tight. You will have tiny stitches on the right side and longer stitches on the wrong side.